

# Instructions for Submitting a Proposal to The Michael J. Fox Foundation for Parkinson's Research

Last verified by Christina Murphy on 08-28-2025

**Introduction:** Thank you for your commitment and contributions to delivering promising new treatments to those with Parkinson's disease. Without you, progress cannot happen. We are excited to see your breakthrough ideas and although we are not able to fund every proposal, we promise to review your application carefully and thoughtfully.

**Overview:** Below please find general instructions related to submitting a proposal to The Michael J. Fox Foundation for Parkinson's Research (MJFF) via [MJFF's Grant Portal](#). All MJFF applications must be received through this portal. Please refer to MJFF's website or your email invitation (for RFP invitations) for the appropriate duration, budget, and scope for your proposal. Project proposal templates are included in the Grant Portal. Please also be sure to note the proposal due date. Proposals submitted after the due date may not be able to be accepted. As noted below, and in the proposal template, if certain items are not relevant to your proposal, such as relevant FDA Meeting Minutes or biosample request forms, they do not need to be included.

**Confidentiality:** All materials submitted to MJFF are considered confidential. MJFF staff and any external reviewers follow and sign MJFF's confidentiality terms.

**Support for your Application:** Should you have any questions regarding your submission, please reach out to the sources below accordingly.

- **RFA Inquiries:** [MJFF's Grants Team](#)
- **RFP Inquiries:** [MJFF's Grants Team](#) or the MJFF Grants Manager, Scientific Lead or Business Lead who invited you to submit.
- **General Grant Portal Support Questions:** [MJFF's Grants Team](#)
- **Forgotten password:** If you have forgotten your password, hit "Forgot Password" on the Grant Portal Login Page at <https://grants.michaeljfox.org/>. You will then receive a link to reset your password.

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## Getting Started: New Users to the MJFF Grant Portal

If you have never applied to MJFF, go to <https://grants.michaeljfox.org/>, hit the “Register Here” button click on the log in page and follow the below steps.

1. **Search for your organization in the Organization Name field.** This will search MJFF’s current database of organizations and input it into the field directly. Please be sure to list your organization name in English.
  - a. If your organization is not found, click “Add New Organization” and complete the organization registration. Please allow 24-48 hours for verification of your organization if it is a new organization being added to the Grant Portal.
  - b. If you are affiliated with more than one institution, pick the primary institution from which you plan to apply. Secondary institutions can be added later.
2. **Complete the Contact and Demographic Information fields**, being sure to use an active email address.
  - a. MJFF requires all portal account holders to create an ORCID number to prevent duplicate names in the grant portal. If an individual does not have an ORCID number, one can be created [here](#). If an individual is not permitted to create an ORCID account, they should contact their Grant Manager or [grants@michaeljfox.org](mailto:grants@michaeljfox.org) for assistance.

3. **Click the Submit button** to submit your registration. Once you have submitted, you will receive an email to the email address provided.
4. Follow the instructions in that email to **set a password and log in to the Grant Portal**.
5. Once you have logged back in, please **fill out as much information about yourself in your profile as possible**. MJFF also recommends selecting the opt-in box regarding receiving emails from MJFF. This ensures that you will receive our Research community emails, including funding opportunities and other Foundation news.

## Getting Started: Returning Users to the MJFF Grant Portal

### Logging in as a Returning User

- If you are a previous MJFF applicant, go to <https://grants.michaeljfox.org/> and enter your login credentials to access the Grant Portal.
  - If you have **received an RFP invitation**, please use the same email address where you received the invitation to apply.
- If you have **forgotten or need to reset your password**, hit “Forgot Password” on the Grant Portal Login Page at <https://grants.michaeljfox.org/>. You will then receive a link to reset your password.

- If you have **changed emails**, please use your former email to log in. Once logged in, click into the circle icon with your first name initial on the upper right-hand corner and select “My Profile”. Here you can update your email and any personal details.
- If you have **changed organizations**, you are required to update your organization prior to submitting your application. If this is the case, please proceed to the step below.

## Updating Your Organization

If you have changed organizations or notice an issue with your organization name, you must update your organization prior to submitting your application. You may request an organization change by taking the steps below:

1. From your homepage, click “Update Profile” or click into the circle icon with your first name initial on the upper right-hand corner and select “My Profile”. Here you can update your email, any personal details and request an organization change.
2. To search for a new primary organization, either click the binoculars icon, the first orange icon to the right of the organization textbox, to open the organization search window OR delete the current organization name and begin typing the new organization directly into the field. A dropdown list of matching options will appear.



The screenshot shows a web form for updating an organization. It features a label "Organization:" followed by a text input field. To the right of the input field are two orange buttons: one with a binoculars icon and another with a circular arrow icon. Below the binoculars button is a dark grey button labeled "Lookup...".

3. Search for the new organization in the Organization search bar. If it does not currently exist in our database, click the “Add Organization if Not Found Above” button and follow the steps to register the new organization. Please enter all organization names in English.

#### GENERAL

Organization:

TEST MJFF ORG\_



Add New Organization

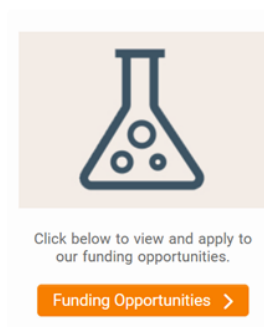
- a. Once you have updated your organization in the Grant Portal, please allow MJFF 24-48 hours for verification of your organization. If you recently created a new organization but it is still listed as pending approval, please try again later.

4. When the correct organization is selected, click Submit.

For further information about changing organizations or adding additional organizational affiliations please refer to [this guidance](#).

## Completing the RFA Pre-Proposal in the MJFF Grant Portal

**Finding a Pre-Proposal Opportunity:** To submit a pre-proposal for an MJFF Request for Application (RFA), please click the funding opportunities icon on your Grant Portal homepage. From there, select the funding opportunity you wish to apply for and hit begin application.



## Filling Out an MJFF Pre-Proposal

Overview: To complete the pre-proposal, fill out the information on the three available tabs: [Project Information & Description](#); [Team Information](#); and [Project Proposal Template](#). All items marked with an asterisk (\*) must be completed. Be sure to hit the “Save My Work” button at the bottom left of the Grant Portal frequently to ensure your pre-proposal work is saved in the portal. It may not be possible to recover lost work and so it is recommended to work on an external document for any items requiring longer written text. Once you begin an application, you may continue to save and return to it before final submission. Once started, the pre-proposal will be accessible through your portal homepage under “Applications in Progress”.

## Project Information & Description tab

### PROJECT INFORMATION

Begin by filling out your Project Title, Project Duration and Project Abstract. When filling out the Project Duration, please be sure to note any guidance from the original funding opportunity. Please note that symbols do not transfer correctly in the Grant Portal system and any symbols should be spelled out (e.g. alpha-synuclein).

**Biosample Requests:** If the funding opportunity allows for biosample requests, you will see a question asking "Will you be requesting biosamples as part of your application?" Please indicate Yes or No. If you select yes, a field will appear requesting that you use [this Biosample guidance](#) to complete the biosample request. **Please follow the steps in this guidance to submit your request. Please note you must complete and submit the activity or the system will prevent you from submitting your application.** For more information about MJFF's available biosamples, please see [MJFF Biospecimen's webpage](#) and [Biobank website](#).

**Resubmission:** If your proposal is a resubmission of a previous proposal, please indicate it here.

### PARTICIPATING INSTITUTIONS

The next step is to list out all organizations that will be involved in your project (participating institutions) in the provided table. The Principal Investigator's institution will have automatically been added to the table as a collaborating institution, but all other organizations will need to be added as “participating institutions.” To add additional participating institutions to the application, applicants can use the + button. You may remove a participating institution by clicking “Open” next to the institution on the table and then clicking “Delete”. There is no preference to the order of the institutions.

When adding participating institutions to the chart, applicants must also assign each institution an appropriate role using the organization definitions below. MJFF recognizes three types of participating institutions:

1. **Collaborating Institutions:** An institution that will contract directly with MJFF and has authority in directing the project. If requesting funds, a collaborating institution will receive funds directly from MJFF. The Principal Investigator's institution is always considered a collaborating institution. **Each additional collaborating institution must have a Co-Principal Investigator assigned to the project.** Additionally, a project may include **no more than three (3) collaborating institutions in total, including the Principal Investigator's institution.**
2. **Consultant Institutions:** Institutions or entities that will provide specific expertise, services, or deliverables to support the project, but do not play a directing role in the overall project strategy or management. They are typically engaged on a fee-for-service or time-limited basis. Consultant institutions may be paid directly by MJFF or through a collaborating institution, depending on the project structure. **These institutions are not counted toward the limit of three collaborating institutions.**
3. **Subaward Institutions:** Institutions that are contracted by a collaborating institution, rather than directly by MJFF. These are often institutions providing a service or resource to a collaborating institution. The collaborating institution will pay the subawardee directly and manage their portion of the project. **These institutions are not counted toward the limit of three collaborating institutions.**

**Important Information while adding multiple institutions:** Once you click the + sign a new window will open so you can add your first participating institution. After you click the Add Participating Institution button, you **must close out the window, return to the main application, and click the + button again to**

**add an additional institution.** You must close out the window after adding each institution or you will overwrite the most recent one. You may remove a participating institution by clicking Open next to the institution on the table and then clicking Delete.

## ADDITIONAL QUESTIONS

Please complete the required additional questions listed so that MJFF can best support your application and team.

## Team Information Tab

### RESEARCH TEAM INFORMATION

Applicants should be sure to list all team members associated with their project in the Research Team Member grid. The main applicant (Principal Investigator) will be automatically added to the table (please be sure not to delete the lead PI entry). By clicking on the Add or Edit Research Team Member Information button, you will be able to add team members to the project. MJFF recognizes three types of roles:

- **Co-Principal Investigators:** Other individuals who have the appropriate level of authority and responsibility to direct the grant and will do so in conjunction with the Principal Investigator. All collaborating institutions on your project must have **at least one Co-Principal Investigator named from each institution**. Please note that there may be **no more than three collaborating institutions** in total, including the Principal Investigator's institution.
- **Paid or Unpaid Collaborators:** Other individuals working on the project who are affiliated with the institution of the Principal Investigator or Co-Principal Investigator(s). You are not required to name paid or unpaid collaborators at the pre-proposal phase, but you may do so.



- **Consultants:** Individuals not affiliated with the institution of the Principal Investigator or Co-Principal Investigator(s) who will play a role on the project and receive a fee for their contributions (rather than a portion of their salary). You are not required to name consultants at the pre-proposal phase, but you may do so.

**Adding to the Research Team Grid:** When adding a person to the Research Team grid, you must fill out their first and last name, institution, position title, email, role on the project, career stage, and ORCID. You will choose their institution from the available institution drop down which will pull from the collaborating institutions and consultant institutions, not the subaward institutions, that you listed in the Participating Institutions Table within the Project Information & Description tab. If this drop down does not appear, be sure to hit save to ensure that the information processed in the system. You will also select the role on the project from the drop-down menu.

Please note that even though the Principal Investigator was entered automatically in the grid, you must still enter the career stage for the PI. Different funding opportunities have varying requirements for Principal Investigator and Co-Principal Investigator career stages, so be sure to reference the funding opportunity guidelines when building your team.

After adding team members, click the Save button, close out the window, return to the application. Click Save My Work at the bottom of the grid again to see the grid refresh.

## Project Proposal Template Tab

### PRE-PROPOSAL

On the Project Proposal Template tab, you will upload your Project Proposal Template as well as any other additional attachments. You should be sure to use the appropriate template for your funding opportunity, which can be found in the Documents section at the top of your application.

Please note that if you use the incorrect template, the Grant Portal system will prevent you from uploading your template. Please be sure to upload the completed template as a PDF.

**Pre-Proposal Confirmation:** Under Pre-Proposal Confirmation and Pre-Proposal Confirmation Signature, please certify that all information is correct and accurate by checking the box and then typing your full name in the box (not your initials).

**Submitting Your Pre-Proposal:** When you are ready to submit your pre-proposal, hit “Save My Work” on the bottom left one final time and click Submit at the bottom center of the application to ensure that your submission is delivered promptly to MJFF.

After you submit, you will receive an email confirmation of your submission. If you do not receive this automatic notification within one hour of submission, please contact MJFF at [grants@michaeljfox.org](mailto:grants@michaeljfox.org) to check on the status of your proposal. Please be sure to check your email’s spam folder before doing so.

The MJFF Grants Team will review your application on the timeline specified in the funding opportunity.

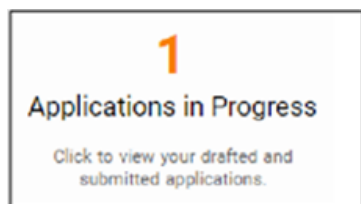
**Troubleshooting:** If you receive an error while trying to submit, that means something in your application needs to be fixed. See [this submission error guide](#) for help with what these errors mean and how to fix them. If your problem cannot be solved using the guidance provided, please email MJFF’s grants team at [grants@michaeljfox.org](mailto:grants@michaeljfox.org) for support.

**Pre-Proposal Next Steps:** All pre-proposals will be reviewed once received. Only pre-proposals determined to best fit the criteria of the funding opportunity will be invited to submit a full application. After pre-proposal review, full application invitations will be communicated via email.

Timelines for each funding opportunity are available on the individual funding opportunity pages on MJFF’s website. Due to the high volume of pre-proposal applications received, written critiques /feedback? are not provided for those not invited to the full application stage.

## Completing the RFA Full Proposal in the MJFF Grant Portal

If you have been invited to submit a full proposal, upon logging into the Grant Portal you will see an Applications in Progress shortcut on your homepage. Click on this and find your proposal with a status of Full Proposal Draft. Click here to continue your application.



## Project Information & Description tab

### PROJECT INFORMATION

Begin by filling out or confirming your Project Title, Project Duration and Project Abstract. If you participated in a pre-proposal phase, you may revise any information, as needed. When filling out the Project Duration, please be sure to note any guidance from the original funding opportunity. Please note that symbols do not transfer correctly in the Grant Portal system and any symbols should be spelled out (e.g., alpha-synuclein).

When filling out the Total Requested Amount, be sure to list your total costs for all institutions in US Dollars. Please note that this field must match the Grant Total cell on the budget template.

Also indicate yes or no if you will need additional funding for the use of Non-Human Primates and add the keywords to best describe your work.

**Biosample requests:** If the funding opportunity allows for biosample requests and you completed the request at the pre-proposal phase, you should have received an email with instructions inviting you to either continue or discontinue the biosample request portion of your application. If invited to continue the request, you will see the biosample request in the Project Information & Description tab. If you have been invited via an RFP to request biosamples, this will be your first time seeing the biosample request activity. Please refer to [this guidance](#) for more information on how to complete the request. RFP applicants must fill out all required fields; RFA applicants must complete one final required item, beyond what was previously submitted, in order to submit the activity. **This activity must be complete and submitted in order to submit your application.**

## Biosample Request

Please use this link for guidance on how to complete the biosample request: [Biosample guidance document](#)

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| #                                                                     | Application ID |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| <div>Open</div> <div></div> <div>1</div> <div>Biosample Request</div> | MJFF-          |

## PARTICIPATING INSTITUTIONS

In the pre-proposal phase, you began filling out the Participating Institutions table with the other organizations that will contribute to your project. At this stage, you will finalize this table.

All organizations that will be involved in your project (called participating institutions) must be listed in the table provided. Applicants should note that the Participating Institutions table must be complete before uploading the budget template to the Attachments tab. As described in the Budget Template section below, alignment is required between the Participating Institutions table and the budget.

As a reminder, the Principal Investigator's institution will have automatically been added to the table as a collaborating institution, but all other organizations will need to be added as “participating institutions.” To add additional participating institutions and their respective roles on the application, applicants can use the + button. You may remove a participating institution by clicking Open next to the institution on the table and then clicking Delete.

Applicants must add participating institutions to the chart leveraging the appropriate organization type. There is no preference to the order of the institutions. MJFF recognizes three types of participating institutions:

1. **Collaborating Institutions:** An institution that will contract directly with MJFF and has authority in directing the project. If requesting funds, a collaborating institution will receive funds directly

from MJFF. The Principal Investigator's institution is always considered a collaborating institution. **Each additional collaborating institution must have a Co-Principal Investigator assigned to the project.** Additionally, a project may include **no more than three (3) collaborating institutions in total, including the Principal Investigator's institution.**

2. **Consultant Institutions:** Institutions or entities that will provide specific expertise, services, or deliverables to support the project, but do not play a directing role in the overall project strategy or management. They are typically engaged on a fee-for-service or time-limited basis. Consultant institutions may be paid directly by MJFF or through a collaborating institution, depending on the project structure. **These institutions are not counted toward the limit of three collaborating institutions.**
3. **Subaward Institutions:** Institutions that are contracted by a collaborating institution, rather than directly by MJFF. These are often institutions providing a service or resource to a collaborating institution. The collaborating institution will pay the subawardee directly and manage their portion of the project. **These institutions are not counted toward the limit of three collaborating institutions.**

**Important information while adding multiple institutions:** Once you click the + sign a new window will open so you can add your first participating institution. After you click the Add Participating Institution button, you must close out the window, return to the main application, and click the + button again to add an additional institution. You must close out the window after adding each institution or you will overwrite the most recent one.

**Additional Questions:** Please complete the required additional questions listed so that MJFF can best support your application and team. If you already submitted a pre-proposal, this will already be filled out, but can be altered at this time.

## TEAM INFORMATION TAB

## RESEARCH TEAM MEMBER INFORMATION

- **Research Team Member Grid Overview:** The Research Team Member grid is where you will finalize the team members associated with your project. Applicants should be sure to list all team members associated with their project in the Research Team Member grid. The main applicant (Principal Investigator) will be automatically added to the table (please be sure not to delete the lead PI entry). By clicking on the Add or Edit Research Team Member Information button, you will be able to add or edit team members to the project. After adding team members, click the Save button, close out the window, return to the application, and click Save My Work to see the grid refresh.
- **Research Team Member Roles:** MJFF recognizes three types of roles:
  - **Co-Principal Investigators:** Co-Principal Investigator(s) (Co-PI) are other individuals who have the appropriate level of authority and responsibility to direct the grant and will do so in conjunction with the Principal Investigator. **All Co-PIs will be required to sign the contract, should funding be allocated.** All collaborating institutions need to have a Co-PI. Please note that there may be **no more than three collaborating institutions** in total, including the Principal Investigator's institution.
    - **If a Co-PI's institution will be covering all research costs for the project, they should still be listed on the Research Team Members grid and invited to collaborate.** In this case, they should be included on the Budget Excel Template with percent effort listed and a salary request of \$0. The nature of the funding should be outlined in the Budget Narrative section.

- **Paid or Unpaid Collaborators:** Paid or Unpaid Collaborators are other individuals working on the project who are affiliated with the institution of the Principal Investigator or Co-Principal Investigator(s) that will be supporting their work. **Paid Collaborator refers to any individual whose salary will be covered by the grant. Unpaid collaborators should be listed on the Budget Excel Template, with percent effort listed, and a salary request of \$0.**
- **Consultants:** Individuals not affiliated with the institution of the Principal Investigator or Co-Principal Investigator(s) who will play a role on the project and receive a fee for their contributions (rather than a portion of their salary).
- **Additional Guidance when considering your Team Grid composition:**
  - **Career Stage:** Many funding opportunities have requirements for Principal Investigator and Co-Principal Investigator career stages. Be sure to reference the funding opportunity guidelines when building your team.
  - **Contributors:** All others involved in your project who do not fit one of the categories above (for example, Grants Manager, Lab Techs, Students, Administrative Assistants, etc.) will be considered a “Contributor”. These individuals should not be listed on the team grid unless they have over 75% effort (please see below).
  - **Individuals with over 75% effort:** Post-Doctoral Fellows, Research Scientists or Research Assistant Professors working more than 75% effort on the project must be named on the Research Team Members grid in their corresponding roles. They can be listed as paid collaborators, unpaid collaborators, or as Co-PIs if the funding opportunity allows. Students and research assistants are not required to be listed on the Research Team Members grid.

- **Community Groups:** If community groups are to be engaged in the proposed project, it is encouraged to add representatives from this group(s) as consultants as well.
- **Subawardee personnel:** If your project requires subaward institutions or subaward personnel, do not include those members on the Research Team Members grid. Those individuals and institutions can be detailed in the subaward section of the budget template and the Team and Budget Narratives of the project proposal template. Please see the [definition of subaward institutions](#) in the Participating Institutions section above.
- **Adding Information to the Research Team Grid:** When adding a person to the Research Team grid, you must fill out their first and last name, institution, position title, email, role on the project, career stage, ORCID and NIH biosketch.
  - **Name:** Please be sure to use full names of individuals rather than nicknames. Please note that special characters, such as accents, do not always transfer correctly in the Grant Portal system.
  - **Institution:** You will choose the institution for each individual from the available institution drop down which will pull from the collaborating institutions and consultant institutions, not the subaward institutions, that you listed in the Participating Institutions Table you filled out on the Project Information & Description tab. If this drop down does not appear, be sure to hit save to ensure that the information processed in the system. You will also select the role on the project from the drop-down menu.
  - **Position Title:** Please share your current role at your institution.
  - **Email:** Please be sure that all emails are correct to ensure that all materials are received in a timely manner.



- **Role on Project:** Please refer to the [summary team grid](#) below for guidance on the various project roles.
- **Career Stage:** Please add the appropriate career stage for each individual. Please note that even though the Principal Investigator was added automatically in the grid, you must still enter the career stage for the lead Principal Investigator. Different funding opportunities have varying requirements for Principal Investigator and Co-Principal Investigator career stages, so be sure to reference the funding opportunity guidelines when building your team.
- **ORCID:** Insert the ORCID numbers for your team here. MJFF requires all team members to have an ORCID number. If an individual does not have an ORCID number, one can swiftly be created [here](#).
- **Biosketches:** A biosketch **must be uploaded for each team member named on the Research Team Member grid**. Each biosketch **must be on the NIH biosketch template** (available for download within the application) and **must not exceed 5 pages**. A biosketch longer than 5 pages will trigger an error when submitting the application.
  - Biosketches may be uploaded to the Grant Portal in two ways: either directly via the button on the Research Team Member grid or through the biosketch activity that is part of the invitation to collaborate process for Co-Principal Investigators, Paid Collaborators, and Unpaid Collaborators (see Invitations to Collaborate section below).
  - If a consultant is listed on the team grid, it is not required to invite them to the invitation to collaborate process, however, if they are listed on the team grid, they must have a biosketch uploaded. While typically this is done by the Principal Investigator or Co-

Principal Investigator, any team member can upload consultant biosketches from within the biosketch activity on behalf of the consultant (see the [Invitations to Collaborate section](#) below for how to do this).

## Summary of Team Grid Roles and Requirements

| Role                      | Listed in Research Team Members Grid | Invitation to Collaborate?                                          | Role Invited In           | Biosketch Needed                       | Acknowledgement of Collaboration Needed |
|---------------------------|--------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|----------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| Co-Principal Investigator | Yes                                  | Required—in order to complete activities and access the application | Co-Principal Investigator | Yes—upload through Bioksketch activity | Yes—through Collaboration activity      |
| Paid Collaborator         | Yes                                  | Required—in order to complete activities and access the application | Paid Collaborator         | Yes—upload through Bioksketch activity | Yes—through Collaboration activity      |

|                                                                               |     |                                                                     |                     |                                                                              |                                    |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----|---------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------|
| Unpaid Collaborator                                                           | Yes | Required—in order to complete activities and access the application | Unpaid Collaborator | Yes—upload through Bioksketch activity                                       | Yes—through Collaboration activity |
| Consultant                                                                    | Yes | Optional—only to be able to access the application                  | Contributor         | Yes—have team member upload to the Research Team Member grid on their behalf | No                                 |
| Others (Grants Manager, Lab Techs, Students, Administrative Assistants, etc.) | No  | Optional—only to be able to access the application                  | Contributor         | No                                                                           | No                                 |

## INVITATIONS TO COLLABORATE

**Overview:** To ensure that the correct team members have appropriate access and are confirmed to participate in the proposal, the lead Principal Investigator must issue “invitations to collaborate” in the Grant Portal. Only with these invitations can team members gain access to the proposal. Please note that only the Principal Investigator can submit the final application.

## Who to Invite to Collaborate

- **Team Members:** At the full proposal stage, all team members listed in roles of Co-Principal Investigator, Paid Collaborator, and Unpaid Collaborator in the Research Team Members grid on the Team Information tab must be invited to collaborate on the proposal and must accept the invitation.
- **Consultants:** Inviting any consultants named on the Research Team Members grid to collaborate on the proposal is optional. Please note that any consultants who are invited must have their biosketch manually uploaded by another team member ([see above](#)).
- **Contributors:** While not required, the PI may also invite administrative team members, such as a Grants Manager, to collaborate on the proposal. This will give those individuals access to the application and enable them to upload documents and complete information on the PI’s behalf. They may be invited but should not be listed on the Research Team Member grid.

## How to Send Invitations

1. Scroll down to the **Invitations to Collaborate** section (under the Research Team Members Grid).  
Under the instructions, you will see a table containing the roles on your team that must be invited to collaborate. This should include whichever team members are on the Research Team Members Grid and who are also listed in the roles of Co-Principal Investigator, Paid Collaborator, and Unpaid Collaborator.

2. To open up the invitation window, click the “Send Invitations” button.
3. To enter in the information of each team member that you would like to invite to collaborate (ensuring that each required team member is listed), click the + button. **It is very important that you use the correct email address for each person being invited and that the email address in the invitation matches the email address listed in the Research Team Members grid. If the person you are inviting already has an account in the Grant Portal, you should confirm the email they use for their MJFF Grant Portal account and send the invitation to that email address accordingly.**
4. Select the role of each person being invited. This should correspond to their role listed on the Research Team Members grid. If you are inviting an administrative team member or a consultant (both optional), select the **Contributor** role.
5. To send the invitations, press “Invite”. You will then see the status change in that section to “Invited”.

## Invitation Tracking

- Pending Invitations: After you send invitations, these invitations can be tracked under “Invitations” on the Team Information tab, where you can see who has accepted. **Please note that you will not be able to submit your application until all invited team members have accepted the invitation. If you need to remove a team member that has already been invited, please email [grants@michaeljfox.org](mailto:grants@michaeljfox.org) for assistance.**

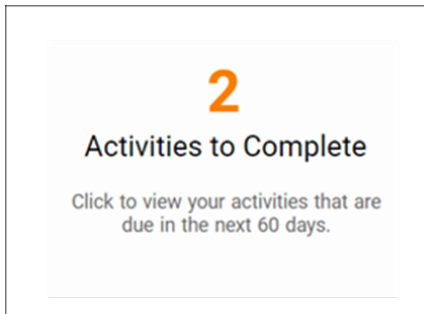
### Invitations

| First Name | Last Name | Email                               | Role                      | Status   |
|------------|-----------|-------------------------------------|---------------------------|----------|
| Sabrina    | Franklin  | sabrina.michelle.franklin@gmail.com | Paid Collaborator         | Accepted |
| Mary       | Hartley   | mhartley@georgetown.edu             | Co-Principal Investigator | Invited  |

- **Inviting Team Members in Stages:** Invitations can be done in stages. As such, you can invite some team members now and go back later to add more team members. To do so, click “Invite” again to invite the new team members and the system will send an invitation to only these newly added team members. **Please be sure to not delete already invited team members if sending invitations in stages. Deleting team members that have already been invited will result in errors in the system.**
- **Please coordinate with colleagues around expected submission date to ensure that invited team members have enough time to complete their activities before the application is due.**

### Receiving an Invitation to Collaborate

- Invited team members will receive an email invitation from [donotreply@michaeljfox.org](mailto:donotreply@michaeljfox.org) with further directions on how to accept their collaboration invite and log in to the system. **They will need to click the link provided in the email in order to accept their invitation.**
- If the person being invited does not already have a Grant Portal account, they will be prompted to create one ([see above for these instructions](#)). They will then be directed to log into the Grant Portal.
- Once the invitee has accessed the Grant Portal, they will see two activities to complete located under the Activities to Complete shortcut on their Grant Portal homepage. The first is an acknowledgement of collaboration activity and the second is a biosketch activity. **Team members should be sure to complete both of these activities, or you will not be permitted to submit your application.**



- **Acknowledgement of Collaboration:** Each invited team member must acknowledge their collaboration on the proposal. This acknowledgement confirms their participation in the project and agreement to their assigned role. To do this, open up the Collaboration activity, input your initials, and click the Acknowledge button.
- **Biosketch:** If you have not already uploaded your biosketch directly on the team grid, please leverage the biosketch activity. Please note that for any consultants listed on the team grid, their biosketch must be uploaded using this activity. To upload the biosketch using the biosketch activity, access the biosketch activity from your homepage where it says “activities to complete”. When you click on the biosketch activity, you will see a duplicate of your team grid. On the right hand side of the grid, you will see orange arrows where you can upload the biosketch. When you click this, a new tab will generate on your web browser where you can search and upload your biosketch as a pdf.

## File Upload

Select File:



Upload

File types allowed: pdf

Once the PDF is uploaded, close out of the second tab. Go back into the main application and check the confirmation box under the team grid and enter your initials. Finally, hit “submit” to complete the activity.

## DIVERSITY, EQUITY, AND INCLUSION

In this section, please provide a brief statement on how you have addressed diversity, equity, and inclusion with respect to the composition of the team that will carry out the funded work.

## ACKNOWLEDGEMENT OF COLLABORATION

All invited team members will be listed in this section. As team members complete their acknowledgement of collaboration activity, the status section will become “complete”. **All team members must complete this activity ([see instructions above](#)) or you will not be permitted to submit your application.**

## Attachments Tab

### BUDGET TEMPLATE

**Overview:** A single project budget on MJFF’s budget template is required for all MJFF projects. Applicants can download the budget template directly from the Attachments tab. This should be completed and **uploaded as an Excel spreadsheet** to the Attachments tab.

For detailed instructions on how to complete the budget template, including information on allowable versus unallowable costs and MJFF’s indirect policy, applicants should refer to the [MJFF Team and Budget Guidelines](#).

**Items to keep in mind while completing the budget:**



- **Do not use any previously downloaded or older templates.** This will trigger a submission error.
- **On the START HERE tab of the budget template, each collaborating institution's name should be written out exactly as it appears on the Participating Institutions table on the Project Information & Description tab. Please note that all institution names must be in English.**
- Please **include all individuals listed in the Research Team Members grid in the budget**, even if their salary is not to be covered by the requested funds (their salary should be entered as \$0.00 and role explained in the budget narrative section).
  - Post-doctoral fellows, Research Scientists, and Research Assistant Professors working more than 75% effort on the project must be named on the Research Team Grid and the Budget Excel Template.
- After you upload your budget, click **Save My Work** to capture the required information and then check the Budget Template Institutions to Correct table (see below).

## BUDGET TEMPLATE INSTITUTIONS TO CORRECT

This area is meant to help troubleshoot with any issues with the budget template. If no institutions are listed in the table, you can skip this section.

If you do see any institutions listed here, it means the system cannot map match? the names of the collaborating institutions entered on the budget template to organizations in our system. If this happens, please open up each institution listed, if any, and choose the correct collaborating institution in the Collaborating Institution drop down. Then click the **Update Institution Name** button to complete the process. **Please note that institution names must be listed in English.**

## COLLABORATING INSTITUTION ATTACHMENTS

**Overview:** For each collaborating institution listed on the Participating Institutions table on the Project Information & Description tab, required documents must be uploaded in order to submit your

application. Click “Upload Documents” next to the institution, upload the required files, click Save, close the window, and re-save your application. The uploaded documents will then appear in the table.

| # | Institution    | Institutional Approval Letter               | Bank Letter                                 | W8 or W9 | Audited Statement                           | Company Overview                            | Management and Ownership Summary            | Patent and License |
|---|----------------|---------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|----------|---------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|--------------------|
| 1 | TEST MJFF ORG, | TEST_MJFF_ORG_Participating_Institution.pdf | TEST_MJFF_ORG_Participating_Institution.pdf |          | TEST_MJFF_ORG_Participating_Institution.pdf | TEST_MJFF_ORG_Participating_Institution.pdf | TEST_MJFF_ORG_Participating_Institution.pdf | TEST_MJFF_ORG_P    |

- **Institutional Approval Letter:** This is required for each collaborating institution. Use the provided template and have it signed by an authorized official, such as someone from the Office of Sponsored Research, or a CEO, CFO, or legal advisor. The approval cannot be signed by a member of the team and team members may not sign their own approval.
- **Bank Letter and W8/W9s (optional):** Bank letters and W8s/W9s are **not required at the proposal stage**. However, if you have your organization’s bank letter or W8/W9 on hand, uploading it now will expedite processing your project should you be selected for funding (these items are required in order to issue project payments). If these items are available, they should meet the following criteria:
  - **Bank letters:** Bank letters must be on bank or institutional letterhead, clearly stating the organization’s name and account details, which may include (but are not limited to): account name, account number, and ABA routing number or Swift/BIC code.
    - If your institution prefers wire payments, in addition to the above bullets, please provide a bank address, account holder address, and intermediary code or IBAN (for foreign institutions).
    - Bank letters must be in English. If a bank letter in English is not available, provide a notarized cover sheet to the non-English bank letter in which you translate the bank details. Attach this to the bank letter and upload it as a single attachment.

- **W8 or W9:** To comply with US Internal Revenue Service (IRS) regulations and issue 1099 forms, a **W-9** is needed for each U.S.-based institution and a **W-8** for each non-U.S.-based institution. Please ensure you upload the most recent W-9 or W-8 on file. If you are unfamiliar with these tax documents, consult the [IRS website](#) or your financial department before uploading.
- **Financial Documents:** For any **for-profit collaborating institution**, these four documents **must** be uploaded.
  - **Audited Statement:** Most recent audited statement such as income statement and balance sheet.
  - **Company Overview:** Include an abstract of your company's overall business plan and how it relates to the proposed research plan. Include an abstract of your company's contributions to the research project including financial and non-financial resources.
  - **Management and ownership summary:** List your company's officers and company shareholders with ownership greater than 10%. Include a short biography (1-page maximum) for each listed individual.
  - **Patent and license information** for all technologies relevant to the proposed research plan: Explain any limitations or payment requirements that could impact the use of the research going forward.

### ADDITIONAL DOCUMENTS TO PROVIDE (IF APPLICABLE)

If any of the below additional documents are applicable to your proposal, select that document in the check box and instructions and an upload field will appear.

- **Ethical Approval Letters:** Ethical entity approval denotes either institutional review board (IRB) approval for clinical work or Institutional Animal Care and Use Committee (IACUC) approval for pre-clinical/animal model work before research can commence. If research is exempted from formal ethics review, please provide an official document confirming exemption. While not required at the application stage, providing this documentation in advance will expedite processing your project should you be selected for funding. If awarded, please note that NO payments will be made until these approval documents have been received.
- **Letter of Intent from Drug Suppliers:** If applicable, please provide a letter of support from the company supplying and packaging your drug product.
- **Copies of Relevant FDA Meeting Minutes or May Proceed Letter:** If your project requires an IND, please provide any associated correspondence or meeting minutes from the regulatory authorities.
- **Investigator's Brochure:** If applicable to your application, please provide an up-to-date Investigator's Brochure. The Investigator's Brochure is a comprehensive document of clinical and nonclinical data on the investigational product. It should summarize the main elements of an entire development program (drug, supplement, device, or other product). This document is of critical importance throughout the drug development process, and should be updated with new information as it becomes available.

- **Therapeutic Profile Template:** If applicable to your application, please provide an up-to-date Therapeutic Profile Template. The Therapeutic Profile Template is a comprehensive form that will aid in the review process and should be completed for the lead compound or series that you would like to pursue as a Parkinson's disease therapeutic. Further instructions on this can be found within the application template.

## Project Proposal Template Tab

### FULL PROPOSAL

In the provided upload box, upload your completed project proposal template. Please ensure you use the template provided for your funding opportunity, which can be found on the Documents section at the top of your application (above Application Instructions). The Grant Portal will prevent you from submitting if a different template is used.

Combine the following sections into **one PDF document**, ensuring that any page limit requirements for the funding opportunity are satisfied.

- Scientific Narrative (required)
- Budget Narrative (required)
- Team Narrative (required)
- Supporting Materials (optional)

### Full Proposal Other Attachments

Please use this section for any other required documents. If you wish to share other documents in support of your proposal, please upload them here. Please do not include any of the sections from your project proposal template here.

### OTHER FUNDING SOURCES

**Overview:** For all collaborating institutions, applicants are required to describe both current and pending funding sources. For each grant, include the title, funding source/ funder name, a brief abstract, annual amount of grant, funding period, and percentage effort of the investigator.

Please keep the following in mind while filling out this section:

- If the Principal Investigator and/or Co-Principal Investigators' total time commitment exceeds 100%, please explain in detail how this will be managed.
- If applicable, specifically state whether there is scientific overlap with the current application. Where there is overlap, please explain.
- If the Principal Investigator and/or Co-Principal Investigators have no other funding (current or pending), a statement should be included to specify this.

## FULL PROPOSAL CONFIRMATION

Under Full Proposal Confirmation and Full Proposal Confirmation Signature, please certify that all information is correct and accurate, that you have not engaged in research misconduct, and that you agree to take responsibility for the project and meet all reporting requirements if a grant is awarded. Check the box to confirm and then type your full name in the box (not your initials). This confirmation is required for submission.

## SAVING AND SUBMITTING A PROPOSAL

**Saving and Returning to a Proposal:** Once you begin an online application, you may save and return to it before final submission. You and your collaborators can access it through your portal homepage under Applications in Progress.

**Submitting a Proposal:** When ready to submit, click the Submit button at the bottom of the application to ensure that your submission is delivered promptly to MJFF. Please note that only the Principal Investigator can submit the final application.

Prior to submitting the application, please ensure that all invited team members have accepted their invitation to collaborate, electronically signed their collaboration effort, uploaded or verified a biosketch.

After you submit, you will receive an automatic confirmation of your submission via email. **If you do not receive this automatic notification within one hour of submission, please contact MJFF at [grants@michaeljfox.org](mailto:grants@michaeljfox.org) to check on the status of your proposal.**

The MJFF Grants Team will review your application on the timeline specified in the funding opportunity.

**Troubleshooting:** If you receive an error while trying to submit, that means something in your application needs to be fixed. See [this submission error guide](#) for help with what these errors mean and how to fix them. If your problem cannot be solved using the guidance provided, please email MJFF's grants team at [grants@michaeljfox.org](mailto:grants@michaeljfox.org) for support.

## Completing an RFP Full Proposal in the MJFF Grant Portal

**Overview:** If you have been invited to participate in an RFP program, begin by referring to the invitation email you received for guidance on how to locate the proposal in MJFF's Grant Portal. Depending on how the funding opportunity was set up, it may be under Applications in Progress OR under Funding Opportunities. If it is your first time using the grant portal, refer to the [guidance here](#) to set up your account. If you are a returning user but require instruction on using the Grant Portal, please refer to the [guidance here](#). Please use the same email address where you received the invitation to apply.

**Biosamples:** If you have also been invited to request Biosamples as part of your RFP application, you will find that a Biosample Request activity has been created for you in your application. Based on the cohort that was listed in your invitation email, you will complete and submit the activity as a part of your application. Guidance on where to find the activity can be found in the [Completing the RFA Full Proposal section](#) of this document. For further information on completing biosample requests, please refer to [this guidance](#).

**Completing an RFP Full Proposal:** Refer to the guidance in the [Completing the RFA Full Proposal section](#) of this document here. Follow the given instructions and ignore any references to the pre-

proposal. Since you are starting with a full proposal you will need to fill out all required items that would normally be captured in a pre-proposal such as the Title and Project duration.